

Atlanta Falcons

Business Development Dossier

Industry	Professional Sports
Revenue	\$550M
Employees	500
Ideal Customer Profile Score	58

ICP SCORING MODEL



ICP = Signals + Revenue + Employees + Fit (max 100)

Signals (0-35)	Top 4 signals scored; each = base(60%) + recency bonus <30d: 40% <90d: 30% <180d: 20% older: 10%
Revenue (0-25)	\$500M-\$10B sweet spot -> 70-100% of 25 pts Below \$500M -> pro-rata x 0.5 Above \$10B -> 60%
Employees (0-20)	2,000+ preferred (70-100%) 500-2K partial (50-70%) Below 500 -> pro-rata x 0.3
Fit (0-20)	High-fit types: reorg, transformation, M&A, hiring, funding, partnership -> 5 pts ea (max 12) + diversity 2/type (max 8)

Prepared March 19, 2026

McChrystal Group

Leadership Advisory & Organizational Effectiveness

SECTION 1

Organization Snapshot

Legal Name	Atlanta Falcons Football Club LLC
Headquarters	Atlanta, Georgia (Mercedes-Benz Stadium)
Founded	1965
Ownership	Privately owned by Arthur Blank (Home Depot co-founder) through AMB Group LLC. Blank also owns Atlanta United FC (MLS).
Footprint	Atlanta metro area. NFL franchise with national brand. Mercedes-Benz Stadium hosts NFL games, MLS games, and major events. Training facility at IBM Performance Field in Flowery Branch, GA.

SECTION 1b

Company Overview

The Atlanta Falcons are an NFL franchise owned by Arthur Blank (Home Depot co-founder). After years of underperformance, Blank executed a wholesale organizational restructuring in January 2026, simultaneously replacing the head coach, general manager, and CEO - a rare three-position leadership reset in professional sports.

SECTION 2

Financial Health & Growth Stage

Understanding Atlanta Falcons's financial position and trajectory is critical to framing any engagement conversation.

NFL franchise revenue estimated at ~\$550M (Forbes 2025 valuation: ~\$4.5B). Revenue streams: NFL media rights (\$370M+/team from 2023 deal), gameday revenue, sponsorships, merchandise. Arthur Blank's personal wealth (~\$8B) ensures financial backing for organizational investment. Key tailwind: NFL's new media rights deals guarantee revenue growth. Key risk: on-field performance drives premium revenue (playoffs, Super Bowl hosting, sponsorship premiums).

SECTION 3

Leadership Team Profiles

The following contacts are recommended as primary outreach targets - champion-level leaders who feel the organizational pain daily and can sponsor McChrystal internally.

Greg Beadles - President and CEO [PRIORITY TARGET]

Business operations executive; managed Mercedes-Benz Stadium and Atlanta United commercial operations
Outreach rationale: As the sole holdover executive, Beadles must bridge between the business operation he knows and the entirely new football operation. He's the organizational connective tissue and the natural champion for McChrystal.

Additional leadership team members relevant to the engagement:

Arthur Blank - Owner

Co-founder of Home Depot; billionaire entrepreneur; known for hands-on ownership style

Matt Ryan - President of Football

Former NFL MVP quarterback; franchise legend; no prior front-office experience

Kevin Stefanski - Head Coach

Former Cleveland Browns head coach (2020-2025); 2-time NFL Coach of the Year

Ian Cunningham - General Manager

Former Philadelphia Eagles VP of Player Personnel

SECTION 4

Organizational Culture & Structure

Culture and structure are often where McChrystal Group finds the deepest leverage. The following signals indicate how Atlanta Falcons operates today and where friction exists.

Organizational Structure

Post-restructuring: three pillars - Business (CEO Beadles), Football Operations (President of Football Matt Ryan + GM Cunningham + HC Stefanski), and Ownership (Arthur Blank). The Matt Ryan appointment is unprecedented - a former player with no front-office experience serving as 'President of Football' bridging ownership and football operations. This creates a novel organizational structure with unclear authority boundaries between Ryan, Cunningham, and Stefanski.

Culture Signals

The Falcons have been defined by the Super Bowl LI collapse (28-3) and subsequent years of underperformance. The wholesale restructuring signals Arthur Blank's frustration with incremental change. The coaching staff, front office, and C-suite are all new simultaneously - meaning there are no established relationships, norms, or communication patterns. Matt Ryan's appointment (beloved as a player, untested as an executive) adds an emotional dynamic. The entire organization is watching whether Ryan's new role is substantive or ceremonial. Blank's reputation for being an engaged, demanding owner adds pressure. [INFERRED: the speed and completeness of the restructuring suggests Blank wants cultural transformation, not just personnel changes]

SECTION 5

Recent News & Trigger Events

The following developments from the past 18 months create urgency and provide natural conversation entry points for engaging Atlanta Falcons.

1. 2026-01-17 - Kevin Stefanski hired as head coach after wholesale coaching and front office firings

New HC must build coaching staff, culture, and game plan from scratch - all while new GM builds the roster

2. 2026-01-17 - Greg Beadles elevated from President to President & CEO, replacing Rich McKay

Business-side CEO transition adds another dimension to the organizational reset

3. 2026-01-17 - Matt Ryan named President of Football - unprecedented role for former player

Novel organizational structure with unclear authority - needs design and clarity

4. 2026-01-17 - Ian Cunningham hired as GM from Philadelphia Eagles

First-time GM building personnel department from scratch alongside new coaching staff

5. 2026-02-01 - Coaching staff finalized - mix of new hires and one key retention (DC Jeff Ulbrich)

New team must build trust, communication, and shared game-planning processes rapidly before the 2026 season

SECTION 6**McChrystal Fit Assessment**

the fit is genuine (wholesale restructuring, building from scratch, military-sports parallel) but professional sports is a Tier 3 industry with no prior McChrystal track record. The 'why this is worth the unconventional bet' rationale: Arthur Blank's Home Depot background means he thinks like a CEO, not just a sports owner - he'll understand the value of organizational advisory if the pitch is framed in business terms.

Primary Problem

Building a high-performing organizational culture from scratch with entirely new leadership across all three pillars (business, football ops, coaching) while navigating an unprecedented structural element (Matt Ryan as non-traditional President of Football) - all under intense public scrutiny and with a fixed deadline (2026 season).

Best McChrystal Capability Fit

McChrystal's Team of Teams operating model for newly-formed organizations. The Falcons need to build shared consciousness and empowered execution from scratch across people who have never worked together - exactly the challenge of forming a new special operations task force. The military parallel is compelling and authentic for a sports context.

Likely Objections to Engagement

NFL franchises may view leadership advisory as unnecessary in a sport where coaching turnover is routine
Arthur Blank may prefer to manage organizational design personally given his entrepreneur background
Budget is not an issue (Blank's wealth), but attention bandwidth may be - many competing priorities

Competitive Advisory Landscape

Sports-specific leadership consultancies
Individual executive coaches (common in pro sports)
McKinsey Sports & Entertainment practice (limited)

SECTION 7

Conversation Entry Points

These questions are designed for a Senior Partner's first conversation. Each opens a thread that naturally leads to McChrystal Group's capabilities without a direct pitch.

1. With Matt Ryan in an unprecedented role, Kevin Stefanski building a new staff, and Ian Cunningham in his first GM job - how are you designing the authority structure so these three can make fast decisions without stepping on each other?

Gets at the core structural challenge. The Matt Ryan role is the most interesting angle - it's novel and needs design.

2. Building a winning culture from scratch with all new people is something General McChrystal has done - literally - in the most high-stakes environments. What if we brought that methodology to the Falcons organization?

Direct military-sports parallel. Simple, compelling, authentic.

Recommended Meeting Framing

This is a personal conversation, not a corporate pitch. Ideally through Blank's business network (Home Depot, AMB Group). Frame as: 'We've helped organizations build high-performing teams from scratch in weeks, not years.'

SECTION 8

Brand Insights & Market Positioning

Brand strategy reveals organizational priorities and coordination challenges. The following analysis connects Atlanta Falcons's market positioning to potential McChrystal engagement opportunities.

The Falcons brand is defined by the Super Bowl LI collapse and subsequent underperformance. The 2026 restructuring is an opportunity to reset the brand narrative - from 'perpetually disappointing franchise' to 'bold organizational transformation.' The Mercedes-Benz Stadium is a brand asset (state-of-the-art, fan-friendly pricing), and Blank's ownership group (including Atlanta United) is a brand umbrella. Matt Ryan's appointment adds a 'prodigal son returns' storyline that national media is covering extensively. [INFERRED: the brand opportunity from a successful 2026 season would be transformative, amplifying the organizational investment]

SECTION 9

Deep McChrystal Group Fit Analysis

This is the strategic case for pursuing Atlanta Falcons. It synthesizes findings from all previous sections into a comprehensive engagement thesis with specific fit dimensions, expected outcomes, stakeholder mapping, and a phased pursuit strategy.

9a. Fit Dimensions

Fit Dimension 1: Building from Scratch

HC, GM, CEO, and President of Football all new simultaneously. There are no established relationships, norms, or communication patterns. McChrystal's methodology for rapidly building shared consciousness in newly-formed units is directly applicable. No sports-specific consultancy offers this - they typically advise on player evaluation or coaching schemes, not organizational operating models.

Fit Dimension 2: Novel Structural Design

The Matt Ryan 'President of Football' role has no precedent. Its authority boundaries with the GM and HC are unclear. McChrystal's organizational design capability - defining decision rights, communication flows, and accountability structures - is exactly what this role needs. This isn't a coaching problem; it's an organizational architecture problem.

Fit Dimension 3: Military-Sports Cultural Translation

McChrystal's military leadership principles (shared consciousness, empowered execution, trust-building under pressure) translate naturally to professional sports. General McChrystal's personal brand resonates with the competitive, mission-driven culture of NFL teams.

9b. Cumulative Case

Signal chain: wholesale leadership reset -> unprecedented structural role (Ryan) -> first-time GM -> new coaching staff -> 2026 season deadline. Every signal compounds: new people, new structure, no established trust, and a fixed deadline.

Revenue potential: \$300K-\$500K organizational design + Team of Teams workshops (3-4 months pre-season), \$200K-\$300K ongoing advisory through the season. Potential expansion to Atlanta United and AMB Group broader portfolio.

Why this unconventional bet is worth it: Arthur Blank is a CEO-turned-owner who built Home Depot into a \$400B company. He understands organizational advisory in business contexts. If McChrystal delivers for the Falcons, Blank's network (Home Depot alumni, Atlanta business community, other NFL owners) is a powerful referral engine.

9c. Enterprise Issues

1. Matt Ryan Authority Ambiguity: The President of Football role has no precedent. Without clear design, it becomes either a figurehead position (wasting Ryan's potential) or a source of conflict (stepping on GM/HC).
2. First-Time GM Growing Pains: Ian Cunningham is in his first GM role, building a scouting and personnel department while establishing his own authority alongside an NFL legend (Ryan) and an experienced HC (Stefanski).
3. Trust Deficit: All new leaders with no prior working relationships. Trust must be built in months, not years, because the 2026 season starts in September.
4. Owner Pressure: Arthur Blank's hands-on style means new leaders must navigate his involvement while establishing their own authority.

5. Public Scrutiny Amplifier: Every organizational decision plays out in national media. Normal growing pains become public narratives.

9d. Expected Outcomes

1. Authority Architecture - Clear decision rights framework for Ryan, Cunningham, and Stefanski. Measurable: zero public authority conflicts through 2026 season.
2. Rapid Trust Building - McChrystal's team-building methodology adapted for NFL context. Measurable: leadership team alignment scores (internal survey) above 80% within 90 days.
3. Communication Operating Model - Information flow between business ops (Beadles), football ops (Ryan/Cunningham), and coaching (Stefanski). Measurable: weekly cross-pillar alignment cadence established within 30 days.
4. Season Readiness - Organizational foundation for on-field performance. Measurable: qualitative assessment from coaching staff and front office that organizational structure supports (rather than hinders) football decisions.

9e. Key Stakeholders

Ownership

Leader: Arthur Blank

Role: Owner/Decision-maker

McChrystal Relevance: Executive sponsor - must endorse engagement

Business Operations

Leader: Greg Beadles

Role: President & CEO

McChrystal Relevance: Priority outreach target - organizational bridge

Football Strategy

Leader: Matt Ryan

Role: President of Football

McChrystal Relevance: Novel role needing design - key beneficiary

Player Personnel

Leader: Ian Cunningham

Role: General Manager

McChrystal Relevance: First-time GM - organizational support valuable

Coaching

Leader: Kevin Stefanski

Role: Head Coach

McChrystal Relevance: Building culture from scratch - team of teams approach

9f. Opportunity Thesis

Why Now: 2026 season starts September. Organizational architecture decisions are being made now (Q1-Q2 2026). Every month of delay makes it harder to establish norms before the season pressure begins.

Why McChrystal: No sports-specific consultancy does organizational operating model design. Executive coaches

work one-on-one. McChrystal works on the system - how people, roles, and authority structures connect. For a franchise building from scratch, the system is everything.

Phased Engagement:

- Phase 1 (\$250K-\$400K, 2-3 months pre-season): Organizational architecture design + team-building workshops for leadership team (Ryan, Cunningham, Stefanski, Beadles, Blank). Beachhead: the Matt Ryan role design - it's bounded, novel, and high-visibility.
- Phase 2 (\$200K-\$300K, in-season): Ongoing advisory and organizational assessment.
- Phase 3 (Expansion): AMB Group portfolio (Atlanta United, PGA Tour Superstore, other Blank entities).

Multi-Threaded Pursuit:

- Thread 1: Greg Beadles - direct outreach as business-side CEO managing the organizational bridge
- Thread 2: Arthur Blank - McChrystal personal network (CEO circles, Atlanta business community, Home Depot alumni)
- Thread 3: Military/veteran angle - check for veteran connections in Falcons organization or coaching staff